

is in the Trash.” Only when the file is flushed from the trash will the alias give you a clueless statement that it could not find the file. You can even manipulate “busy” files on OS X. If a file is open in MS Word and you try to rename or move it, Windows will reprimand you for trying to do so. Mac OS X will not. You can easily rename and even move a file while it is in use by some program. You won’t lose anything so even saving the file is not required. If you rename a file while it is in use, the application it is open in will automatically reflect the change.

5.3.7 Drag And Drop

Is this a feature worthy enough to merit its own heading? You bet it is. Given that the Macintosh was the first computer to bring the mouse with its drag and drop capabilities to the table, it is hardly a surprise that Mac OS X has complete support for drag and drop throughout the operating system. You can pluck any image, link or text from a web page in Safari and drop it anywhere on the hard drive. So you can pick a sentence from a webpage, invoke Dashboard, and drop it onto the translation widget, pick an image and drop it onto the iPhoto icon, or drag any link and drop it onto a Web browser to open it. But this is just the basic functionality. Select any text and drag it onto the Desktop to save it as a text clipping. You can even activate Exposé while dragging something, so you could drag an image onto a Finder window and save it anywhere. Mac OS X has spring-loaded folders, so when you drag an item onto a folder, it automatically springs open to allow you further access to the innards. You can drag files and folders into dialog boxes to automatically take you to that location in the folder hierarchy. Dragging CDs and other peripherals onto the trash ejects them, Mail starts a new message addressed to it when an e-mail address is dropped on its icon, dragging anything onto it adds it to the dock, etc. This extensive support for drag and drop makes using Mac OS X much less of a drag (pun unavoidable) when compared to competing operating systems.

5.3.8 Drawbacks

Not everything is perfect in the little kingdom of Apple, though. There are various little annoyances all over the operating system that